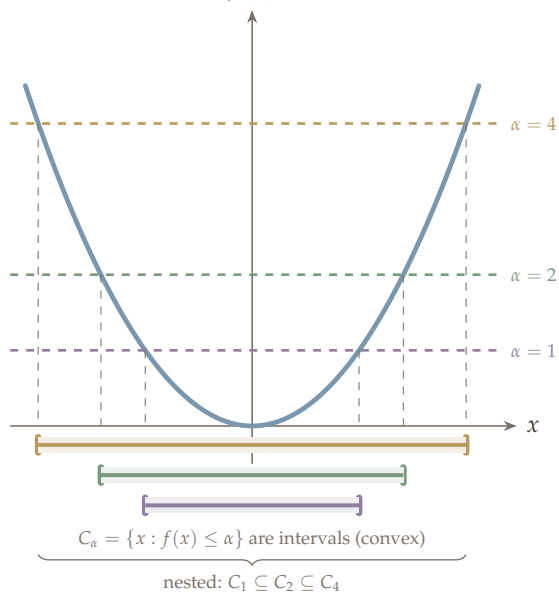
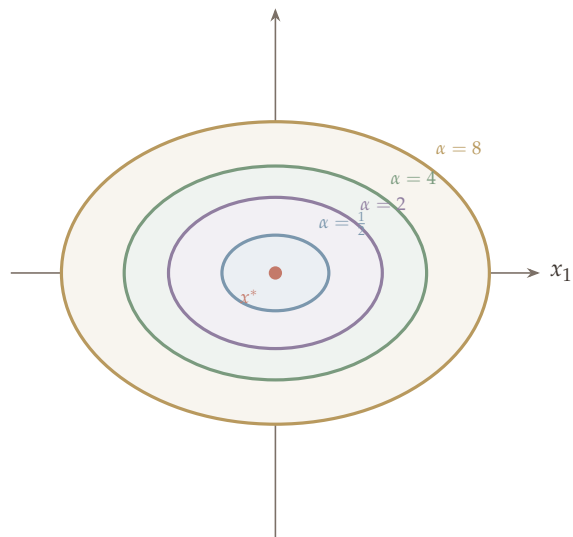


(a) Sublevel sets of $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^2$



(b) Sublevel sets of $f = x_1^2 + 2x_2^2$



Nested convex ellipses, shrinking toward x^*